



another R, Rishabh Pant, who scored a century in the second innings in his comeback Test match. Pant is turning out to be as popular with teammates and opponents as Vishy was, and with him back to form with his chirping behind the stumps, the entertainment factor has gone up manifold. It was also good to see Shubman Gill getting another classy hundred.

Speaking of allrounders, with Hardik Pandya not yet ready, or so it seems, to bowl more overs, it might be a good idea for the selectors to encourage Venkatesh Iyer to bowl a bit more in the Ranji Trophy. He was not part of any team in the Duleep Trophy, but he is a quality player and a left-handed batter to boot and should be kept an eye on, along with young Nitish Reddy.

Abhimanyu Easwaran's two hundreds in the

Troubleshooters-in-chief: Ravichandran Ashwin and Ravindra Jadeja put their hands up everytime India is in a spot of bother. R. RAGU

Duleep Trophy also should not be overlooked, for in Australia, India will need players who can play the short ball. It would be better to go with more opening batters in the squad as they can bat not only at the top but also in the middle order.

Well begun is half done, so India have started the red ball season with a terrific all-round performance to beat a highly confident Bangladesh. They know there are sterner battles ahead, and the going could get a bit more rough than what was seen in Chennai.

It would be better to go to Australia with more opening batters in the squad as they can bat not only at the top but also in the middle order.